

*Bosnia and Herzegovina Report on the
Implementation of the Convention and
Recommendation against Discrimination in Education,
1960*

(2017-2020)

Ministry of Civil Affairs of Bosnia and Herzegovina

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I Information on legal, judicial, administrative and other measures implemented at the state level

The Convention against Discrimination in Education was adopted on 14 November 1960 in Paris. On 12 July 1993, Bosnia and Herzegovina successively adopted the Convention against Discrimination in Education (after the dissolution of the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia).

The Constitution of Bosnia and Herzegovina is the most important legal and political document that defines Bosnia and Herzegovina as a state consisting of two entities: the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina and the Republic of Srpska, and the Brčko District of BiH, as separate administrative unit under state sovereignty. Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina consists of ten cantons.

The Constitution of Bosnia and Herzegovina is inspired by the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, the Declaration on the Rights of Persons Belonging to National or Ethnic, Religious or Linguistic Minorities, and other instruments for human rights. The basic principles of respect for human dignity, tolerance, freedom and equality are enshrined in the BiH Constitution.

The Constitution of the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina guarantees the application of the highest level of internationally recognized rights and freedoms referred to in Annex I of the Constitution. In Chapter II (Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms), Article 2, paragraph 1, specifically lists the catalogue of human rights enjoyed by all persons in the territory of the FBiH. Chapter III of the FBiH Constitution - Division of Competences between the Federal and Cantonal Authorities - states that education is the responsibility of the cantons in the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina.

The Constitution of the Republic of Srpska (Chapter II - Human Rights and Freedoms) states that all citizens of the Republic of Srpska are equal in freedoms, rights and duties, are equal before the law and enjoy the same legal protection regardless of race, gender, language, nationality, religion, social origin, birth, education, political and other beliefs, social status or other personal characteristics. Also, this chapter, Article 38, states that everyone has the right to education under equal conditions, and that primary education is compulsory and free, and that secondary and higher education is available to all.

The Statute of the Brčko District of BiH, in Article 15, states that every child in the District has an equal right to education without discrimination. The primary education is compulsory and free. Secondary education is also free and may be compulsory if required by District law.

Taking into account the constitutional framework of Bosnia and Herzegovina, it can be concluded that ten cantons in the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, Republic of Srpska and Brčko District of BiH have direct competence in education, which requires a high degree of coordination in education at the level of Bosnia and Herzegovina. Since 2003, Ministry of Civil Affairs of Bosnia and Herzegovina took that role, and in accordance with the Law on Ministries and Other Administrative Bodies of Bosnia and Herzegovina (Article 15), this Ministry is in charge of performing tasks that are within the competence of Bosnia and Herzegovina and which relate to determining the basic principles of coordinating activities, harmonizing the plans of entity authorities and defining the strategy at the international level in the field of education.

All cantons in the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, the Republic of Srpska and the Brčko District of BiH have their own ministries of education, laws in the field of education, education budgets. The FBiH Ministry of Education and Science has a coordinating role in cooperation with the cantonal ministries of education, has a budget for education and uses it mainly to ensure the right to education.

Since its establishment in 2003, the Ministry of Civil Affairs has initiated the adoption of four framework laws and the Law on the Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina, as follows:

Framework Law on Preschool Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 88/7);

Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 18/3);

Framework Law on Secondary Vocational Education and Training in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 63/08);

Law on the Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 88/07) and

Framework Law on Higher Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 59/07 and 59/09).

State-level legislation in the field of education is based primarily on the most important international declarations and conventions governing human rights and freedoms. All laws at the cantonal, entity and Brčko District level must be harmonized with the laws at the level of BiH.

Framework Law on Preschool Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina in Article 6 (Prohibition of discrimination), paragraph (1), provides that “every child shall have equal access and equal opportunities to participate in appropriate upbringing and education, without discrimination on any grounds“. Article 10 (Right to Language) emphasizes that the language and culture of all

constituent people and any national minority living in Bosnia and Herzegovina shall be respected and included in preschool education in accordance with the Constitution of Bosnia and Herzegovina, the European Convention on Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms, the Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities and the Convention on the Rights of the Child.

Article 3 of the Framework Law Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina defines the general objectives of education, which include, inter alia: the promotion of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms and the preparation of every person for life in a society that respects the principles of democracy and the rule of law; ensuring equal opportunities for education and choice at all levels of education, regardless of gender, race, nationality, social and cultural origin and status, family status, religion, psychophysical and other personal characteristics.

Article 8 of the Framework Law on Secondary Vocational Education and Training (Curriculum Development and Content) stipulates, inter alia, that the education of children belonging to national minorities shall be carried out on the basis of the Law on Protection of the Rights of National Minorities in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 12/03 and 76/05), in the language and script of the national minority, in accordance with the provisions of this Law and other laws governing the education system in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

The Framework Law on Higher Education in BiH also emphasizes that higher education is based, inter alia, on respect for human rights and civil liberties, including the prohibition of all forms of discrimination. Also, this law defines that access to higher education have all those who have completed a four-year secondary school in Bosnia and Herzegovina, and that access to higher education will not be limited, directly or indirectly, on any real or presumed basis, such as: gender, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, skin colour, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, etc.

Ten cantons in FBiH, Republic of Srpska and Brčko District of BiH have their own laws for all levels of education which should be in accordance with the mentioned framework laws.

Strategic documents in the field of education have been adopted at the level of BiH, which directly or indirectly promote respect for human rights and freedoms, as well as the prohibition of any form of discrimination in education. Here are some of them:

Platform for the development of preschool education in BiH for the period 2017-2022 (Official Gazette of BiH, number 2/18); Strategic platform for the development of adult education in the context of lifelong learning in Bosnia and Herzegovina for the period 2014-2020 (Official Gazette of BiH, number 96/14); Priorities for the development of higher education in BiH for the

period 2016-2026 (Official Gazette of BiH, number 35/16); Principles and standards in the field of adult education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 39/14), etc.

II Information on the application of the Convention and Recommendation

Laws at all levels of government, as well as at all levels of education, ensure that every individual has an equal right of access and equal opportunities to participate in appropriate education, without discrimination on any grounds.

In addition to laws prohibiting discrimination in education, the competent education authorities are taking a number of activities, in accordance with the financial possibilities, in order to provide education to all on equal terms. In this regard, we will mention the FBiH Ministry of Education and Science, which through several of its programs allocates funds and provides support to programs and projects aimed at eliminating discrimination in education. These are the following programs: “Support for projects to improve the inclusiveness of preschool and primary education”, Support to projects for hiring Roma mediators in order to increase the coverage and regular attendance of primary education of Roma children”, etc.

Also, the program "Support to training programs, vocational training and professional development of adults with a focus on women for easier integration into the labour market", which the FBiH Ministry of Education and Science implements through a public call, provides financial support to public secondary school programs aimed at improving the skills and competencies of adults with a focus on women through a program of training, vocational training or professional development, in order to facilitate their integration into the labour market.

Ensuring quality education for all students, for those with disabilities and for gifted students at all levels of education, is one of the most pressing issues when it comes to inclusion in Bosnia and Herzegovina. In Bosnia and Herzegovina, conditions are being created for the implementation of the inclusion process through adequate education and support to educators, teachers and professors in the form of assistance from experts of various profiles in the development of individualized curriculum.

Within the joint project of the European Union and the Council of Europe "Regional Support to Inclusive Education", which was completed in November 2015, an Action Plan for the implementation of recommendations contributing to the improvement of inclusive education and further development of inclusive education policies was developed.

Preschool education

Although preschool education is not explicitly defined by the Convention, the international community is increasingly recognizing the importance of early growth and development, and in the current context of the 2030 Education Program, in line with SDG 4.2, more attention is being paid to providing at least one year of free and compulsory preschool education.

When we talk about preschool education in Bosnia and Herzegovina, we can say that in most cantons in FBiH, preschool education is mandatory only in the year before starting primary school and these are short-term programs. Only these short programs before starting primary school are free. These programs include children aged 5 to 6 years. The duration of shortened free programs in the year before starting primary school is 150 hours in most cantons that implement this program, but in some areas the program lasts longer (It lasted for 300 hours in Canton 10).

In the Republic of Srpska, this program is not mandatory, but it is still being implemented. The program was fully introduced (100 % coverage of children with preschool education in the year before starting school) in Tuzla Canton, Zenica – Doboј Canton, Sarajevo Canton, Brčko District of Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bosnian – Podrinje Canton Goražde and Canton 10.

In order to improve preschool education in Bosnia and Herzegovina, the Council of Ministers of Bosnia and Herzegovina, at its 123rd session, held on 4 December 2017, at the proposal of the Ministry of Civil Affairs, decided to adopt the Platform for the Development of Preschool Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina for the period 2017-2022. The platform follows the policies, objectives and practices of European countries. With its adoption, Bosnia and Herzegovina has committed itself to continuous progress in the development of preschool education. The platform includes five specific objectives: increasing the coverage of children with preschool education, ensuring the quality of preschool education, ensuring regular funding, strengthening inclusion and sensitizing society to the importance of preschool education. Environments that have enacted their own laws in line with the Framework Law, mainly implement the specific objectives of the Platform, to a greater or lesser extent. In the past period, most work was done on increasing the coverage of children with preschool education, quality assurance and regular financing of preschool education, as well as on strengthening inclusion.

The Framework Law on Preschool Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina and the Platform for the Development of Preschool Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina for the period 2017-2022 represent the legislative and strategic framework for the development of preschool education in Bosnia and Herzegovina, which promotes and affirms the principle of non-discrimination in preschool education.

Primary and secondary education

In the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in BiH, Article 16 clearly specifies that primary education is compulsory and free for all children. Primary education lasts for nine years, and children begin with primary education at the age of six. Please note here that primary education is free in the sense that parents are exempt from paying tuition. The Federal Ministry of Education and Science, in cooperation with the Cantonal Ministry of Education and Science,

is implementing a project to purchase free textbooks, primarily for students from families in a state of social need, and some cantonal ministries of education are doing the same. Local self-government units finance transportation costs for primary school students living at a certain distance from the school, which is regulated by cantonal, entity and Brčko District regulations (mainly Pedagogical Standards and Norms for Primary Education).

Difficulties that the competent education authorities face are inclusion and the completion of primary education for Roma children, due to frequent migration, as well as the lack of teaching aids and technology in working with children with disabilities. However, the work of schools is organized in such a way as to take into account the needs related to the upbringing and education of children with disabilities, such as fewer classes and an increased number of teaching assistants.

Secondary education

The secondary education system in BiH includes programs of grammar schools, art and religious schools, four-year vocational schools (technical, economic, health, etc.), three-year vocational schools and adult education and training.

In the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in BiH, Article 17 states that secondary education will be available to all, depending on the achievements in primary education, personal interests and abilities. Secondary education in public institutions is free in accordance with the law.

Thus, regular secondary education is free (in the sense that tuition fees are not charged) and is financed from the budget of the competent education authorities and is available to all under equal conditions.

According to the competent ministries of education, a certain percentage of children drop out of secondary education, which is why in Sarajevo, Bosnia-Podrinje and Una-Sana cantons, the law prescribes compulsory secondary education with a two-year duration. Unfortunately, the experiences from the cantons that have prescribed this type of education by law show that laws remain unenforceable in practice if they are not accompanied by quality bylaws, plans and programs, and most importantly, secured financial resources in budgets. Thus, students rarely acquire a qualification through this type of secondary education with a two-year duration.

Higher education

The Framework Law on Higher Education in BiH, in Article 7, states that higher education is available to all who have completed a four-year high school in Bosnia and Herzegovina. Higher education is aimed at the full development of the human personality, respect for human rights, civil and other rights and freedoms. Article 7 also states that access to higher education provided

by licensed higher education institutions in Bosnia and Herzegovina shall not be restricted, directly or indirectly, on any actual or presumed basis, such as: gender, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, skin color, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, etc.

In addition to the Framework Law defining the field of higher education in BiH, Priorities for the development of higher education in BiH for the period 2016-2026 have been developed, which represent the main measures and activities to be implemented in Bosnia and Herzegovina to strengthen the development of higher education, and to achieve its full involvement in the European Higher Education Area.

The priorities for the development of higher education are grouped into seven key areas: good governance and management; resources; the link between the labour market and higher education; qualification standards; student experience; internationalization and statistics.

For the purpose of better connection between the higher education and the labour market, the document Priorities for the Development of Higher Education in the period 2016-2026, among other things, envisages the following: modernization of existing and increasing the number of study programs for qualifications required in the labour market; developing career advice and publicly promoting information as an incentive to enrol for a qualification; providing scholarships for deficient study programs; limiting the number of students in programs where staff overproduction has occurred; clearly defining the goals that higher education institutions (HEIs) should achieve in relation to the labour market, as well as indicators of achievement; harmonization of new titles so that they can be used without any problems on the entire territory of BiH.

Legislation and practice in the field of recognition of higher education qualifications for employment needs to be improved and public budgets should include items for financing graduate students - entrepreneurs, and programs for gaining experience abroad for graduates in the field of growth and innovation should be developed, provided they return and apply their skills and knowledge in BiH. Higher education institutions are constantly working on improving study programs, especially on the gradual introduction of new educational profiles and study programs required by the labor market, but the realization of this activity depends on available funds and the availability of teaching staff. In the context of improving the legislation and practice in the field of recognition of higher education qualifications, a Model for academic recognition of qualifications in public higher education institutions has been developed, which is fully based on the Lisbon Recognition Convention and its accompanying documents.

Adult education

During 2014, the Council of Ministers of Bosnia and Herzegovina adopted two documents of special importance for the development of adult education:

- a) Principles and standards in the field of adult education in BiH and
- b) Strategic platform for the development of adult education in the context of lifelong learning in BiH for the period 2014-2020.

Principles and standards in the field of adult education in BiH is a comprehensive strategic document in which adult education is defined as an integral part of the education system in Bosnia and Herzegovina and an activity of special public interest which as such is a high social priority. Such a social status of adult education derives from its goals that have a high social value and relate to: improving the educational and qualification structure of the population, sustainable socio-economic development, achieving greater employability and increasing flexibility and mobility of the working population, development of democracy, intellectuality and tolerance, improving the quality of life, building a learning society and BiH integration into the European social and economic space. The basic condition for achieving the aforementioned objectives are standards, the consistent application which ensures the recognizable status of organizers of adult education and the educational process, regardless of national, ethnic, cultural, economic and other specifics of the environment in which education is conducted. The agreed standards relate to: types and programs of adult education, status of participants, status of organizers of adult education, conditions for performing activities, accreditation of organizers and programs, validation of prior learning, educational documents, records, documentation and databases on adult education, statistics and research of adult education, social dialogue, partnership and cooperation in the field of adult education, planning, financing and monitoring of adult education policies.

The Strategic Platform for the Development of Adult Education in the Context of Lifelong Learning in BiH for the period 2014-2020 represents the legal framework and basis for action and cooperation of competent bodies, institutions, organizations and individuals at all levels of government in Bosnia and Herzegovina, in terms of adoption and full implementation and / or other development documents related to adult education. The platform determines the global directions of adult education development in Bosnia and Herzegovina for the period 2014-2020 and establishes the basis for a systematic cross-sectoral approach to strategic planning of adult education development in Bosnia and Herzegovina and initiates necessary reform processes that should contribute to greater competitiveness in the knowledge and labour market, increased mobility and professional flexibility of the individual, and socio-economic revitalization.

In the period from 2009 to 2017, the basic legislative framework for adult education was adopted in a number of cantons in FBiH and Republic of Srpska. The adopted laws are mainly based on the Principles and Standards in the field of adult education in Bosnia and Herzegovina and in most cases regulate issues such as: performing adult education activities; general issues related to the establishment, organization, financing, management and administration of the adult education process; conditions for performing adult education, rights and obligations of participants, conditions for obtaining public documents and other issues important for performing the activity of adult education.

Laws on adult education in BiH have been enacted in the Republic of Srpska, Una-Sana Canton, Tuzla Canton, Bosnia-Podrinje Canton of Goražde, Zenica-Doboj Canton, West Herzegovina Canton, Sarajevo Canton, Central Bosnia Canton, Canton 10 and Herzegovina-Neretva Canton.

Rights of national minorities

- Constitutional law and / or legislation protects the right of national minorities to education –

Among the numerous documents on human rights and fundamental freedoms, that Bosnia and Herzegovina has ratified or accepted by succession, the following stand out:

Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1984) and European Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms (1950), (Article 2.2 of Annex 4 of the General Framework Agreement for Peace in Bosnia and Herzegovina) by which BiH undertook to "ensure to all persons under its jurisdiction the rights and freedoms contained in the Convention and its protocols" (Article 1 of the Protocol 1 with Convention).

In terms of the right of national minorities to education, the International Covenant on Economic, Cultural and Social Rights (1966) recognizes the right of everyone to education, emphasizing that education "should enable everyone to play a useful role in a free society, to promote understanding, tolerance and friendship among all people and all races, ethnic or religious groups ... " (Article 13 of the International Covenant).

The right to education was also confirmed by the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989), which includes the right to primary, general secondary, general vocational and higher education (Article 28 of the Convention), while Article 29 deals with further targeted education of the child.

The Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities is one of the most important documents dealing with the protection of human rights and fundamental freedoms of persons belonging to national minorities. In this regard, States parties undertake to promote "equal access to education for persons belonging to national minorities at all levels" (Article 12.3) and "the right of every person belonging to a national minority to learn the language of his or her minority" (Article 14.1).

The European Charter for Regional or Minority Languages (1992) attaches great importance to the right to education, where Article 8 sets out extensively the obligations of States to provide pre-school, primary, general secondary, technical and secondary vocational education, higher education, adult education in the relevant regional or minority language, and to enable the teaching of history or culture, the training of teachers and the establishment of a supervisory body. Both Bosnia and Herzegovina's post-accession obligations to the Council of Europe and its pre-accession obligations for full membership in the European Union (Copenhagen and Madrid Criteria) are extremely important.

- Legislation and legal provisions protect the right of national minorities to be educated in their mother tongue -

The right to education of national minorities in Bosnia and Herzegovina relies, first of all, on the Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities of the Council of Europe, on the basis of which the Law on the Protection of the Rights of Persons Belonging to National Minorities was created (2003). This law regulates that members of national minorities, in addition to the rights they enjoy as citizens of Bosnia and Herzegovina, enjoy additional protection and rights, both in the field of education and in the field of history, culture, customs, traditions, language, script, religious freedoms, etc.

The Framework Law on Preschool Education in BiH, as well as the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in BiH include the rights of national minorities.

Also, laws in the field of education, at the entity or cantonal level, as well as the laws of the Brčko District of BiH, take into account the rights of national minorities.

- The curriculum is adapted to the needs of national minorities –

At its 155th session held on 25 September 2018, the Council of Ministers of BiH adopted the Framework Action Plan on the Educational Needs of Roma People in Bosnia and Herzegovina for the Period 2018 to 2022 (it should be emphasized that the Roma minority is the most numerous in BiH), for which the Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees of BiH is responsible. This plan consists of three objectives and fifteen measures and has four units.

The first contains the right of national minorities to education, the second contains elements and recommendations on the basis of which the competent ministries of education should prepare and adopt their action plans, the third contains goals and measures related to the Romani language, history and culture, and the fourth contains the monitoring and evaluation of the Framework Action Plan on the educational needs of Roma in BiH.

The Framework Action Plan envisages measures through three objectives:

Objective 1: "Contents on Roma history and culture included in existing curriculum and textbooks until 2021" (measures: removing possible prejudices and stereotypes about Roma from textbooks and teaching materials; improvement of curriculum and school textbooks by creating thematic units and contents related to Roma history and culture without stereotypes; preparation of professional literature on the history and culture of the Roma or providing the same from the environment).

In the area of discrimination, the following measures are envisaged:

Objective 3: "Prevention of prejudice, stereotypes and discrimination until 2020" (measures: develop a guide for school administration, teachers, kindergarten staff, parents and children in order to get acquainted with the traditions, culture and customs of the Roma; promote the Guidelines for the Prevention of Discrimination in Education; organize training for school administration, teachers, parents and children in order to recognize discrimination, stereotypes and prejudices and the involvement of Roma mediators in education).

- Teachers are trained to adapt to the needs of national minorities –

Framework Action Plan on the Educational Needs of Roma in Bosnia and Herzegovina for the period from 2018 to 2022 in Objective 2 – "Romani language introduced in schools as an optional subject or through alternative solutions by 2022" provides the following measures: (providing professional training of teachers or professors of Romani language at higher education institutions and introduction of Romani language in schools as an optional subject)

The continuous process of monitoring the Framework Action Plan on the Educational Needs of Roma in BiH will be carried out through the Report on the implementation of action plans of the entities / District / cantons.

The first report on the implementation of the Framework Action Plan and local Action Plans should be finalized by the second half of 2020, for the preparation of which the Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees of BiH is responsible.

Rights of refugees and migrants

- Legal and political framework that protects the right to quality education of refugees in BiH –

Article 12 of the Law on Ministries and Other Administrative Bodies of Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of BiH, number 5/03, 42/03, 26/04, 42/04, 45/06, 88/07, 35/09, 59/09, 103/09, 87/12, 6/13, 19/16 and 83/17) defines the competence of the Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees of BiH to take care of the rights and issues of refugees and foreigners under subsidiary protection in BiH after determining their status. The Parliamentary Assembly of BiH has adopted the Strategy in the field of migration and asylum and the Action Plan for the period 2016-2020. The strategy identifies key roles and actors in the implementation process.

In accordance with Article 78, paragraph (4) of the Law on Asylum (Official gazette of BiH, number 11/16 and 16/16), the Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees is responsible for ensuring access to the following rights for refugees and foreigners under subsidiary protection in BiH: information on rights, accommodation, work, education, health care, social assistance and assistance in joining BiH society. The same law stipulates that the Ministry, after consulting with the Ministry of Security of BiH, adopts bylaws on the manner of exercising the rights of refugees and foreigners under subsidiary protection in BiH.

In Bosnia and Herzegovina, there are currently 73 people in refugee status and 59 people in subsidiary protection status.

The Rulebook on the Manner of Exercising the Right to Education of Persons Granted International Protection in BiH (Official Gazette of BiH, number 42/17) prescribes the manner in which refugees and foreigners under subsidiary protection attend preschool, primary, secondary and higher education in BiH.

Higher education of refugees and foreigners under subsidiary protection is provided in accordance with the current legislation governing this area in BiH (in the FBiH at the cantonal

level, in the Republic of Srpska at the entity level), and the Ministry does not provide funding for either full-time or part-time higher education for these persons.

- Measures adopted by state and local authorities to ensure the right of refugees to education –

The Ministry has taken all measures to include children in refugee status or subsidiary protection status in traditional education.

All children are included in the education system of BiH, which includes preschool education, primary, secondary and higher education. Children are also included in afterschool care, playgroups, sections, language courses. Through non-governmental organizations, trainings for people working in education were organized, as well as initiatives to promote diversity. An alternative administrative procedure for enrollment in primary and secondary schools is also provided, as well as the equivalence and nostrification of diplomas, which is prescribed by the Rulebook.

A total of 21 children attend the school in the school year 2019/2020, of which 17 children attend primary school and 4 children secondary school. 9 children are educated in the Sarajevo Canton (1 foreigner under subsidiary protection and 10 refugees), and 12 are in the City of Mostar (12 refugees).

For all children included in the education system, the BiH Women's Initiative, with which the BiH Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees has signed a cooperation protocol, ensured that children receive textbooks and school supplies from school, or through a Centre for Social Work, or through the municipality. Children who are entitled to child allowance can also be entitled to free school lunch.

School transportation for the users of the Refugee Centre "Salakovac" was provided by the Ministry for high school students, the City of Mostar for elementary school students, and the Ministry of Education of Sarajevo Canton for students in the area of Sarajevo.

As for other innovative measures, at the initiative of the Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees of BiH, scholarships were provided for gifted students.

At the end of 2019, 187 asylum seekers (families with children) were accommodated in the Refugee Centre "Salakovac" and the Readmission Centre in Mostar, managed by the Ministry of Human Rights, of which 101 children were under the age of 17.

In accordance with the obligation for accessibility and access to education for these children, the Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees of BiH, in cooperation with non-governmental organizations, conducts pedagogical and educational workshops with children in these centres, although these children would need access to education (BiH Ministry of Security).

The Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees, in accordance with the Convention on the Rights of the Child and regulations in BiH relating to the care and protection of children, requested the Ministry of Security of BiH to provide them with access to the education system in Herzegovina-Neretva Canton, which has not been realized to date.

The BiH Ministry of Human Rights and Refugees will continue to ensure access to the right to education for refugees and persons under subsidiary protection while in status, raise awareness and inform about equal treatment and access to this right in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

III Methods used to draw the attention of various authorities in the country to documents and to remove obstacles

All principles of non-discrimination have been incorporated into the framework laws in the field of education in BiH with the aim of raising awareness of the need to enable and promote equal educational opportunities for all.

Work on improving the conditions of education, equal access and non-discrimination is a constant, continuous and unpredictable process in which much more needs to be invested through education of parents, students and entire school staff, through changing awareness in society about others and different, through various events, through organizing round tables, workshops, seminars and conferences at the local and state level, and promotion through the media.